

ChatGPT Version 5.2

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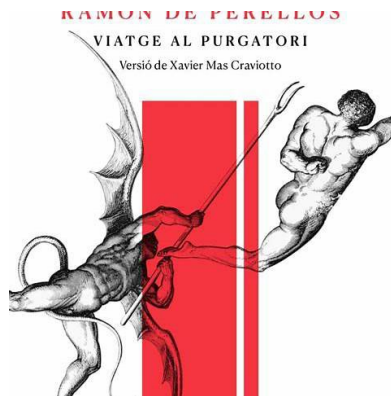
You said:

I need help researching the history of one of Violant de Bar's most trusted friends, the Viscount of Roda. The Viscountess was also a friend of Violant's. Are there any encyclopedia entries on the Viscount of Roda in the 1380s and 1390s? How much information is there in the secondary literature about their biographies? Please provide me with information about them and links for further reading.

ChatGPT said:

I'll look up who the "Viscount of Roda" and his wife were in the 1380s–1390s, then pull together the best encyclopedia-style entries and key secondary scholarship with links and a quick bio summary.

Thought for 2m 9s



Who was the “Viscount of Roda” in the 1380s–1390s?

In the reign of **Joan I (r. 1387–1396)**, the *vescomte de Roda / Rueda* who shows up as a close royal court figure is **Ramon de Perellós** (a Roussillon noble), who is commonly styled:

- **“Ramon de Perellós, vescomte de Roda (Rueda) i de Perellós”** (Viscount of Roda/Rueda and, from 1391, Viscount of Perellós).

This is almost certainly the person you mean when you describe “one of Violant de Bar’s most trusted friends” in the 1380s–1390s, because he is repeatedly documented as a **trusted counselor/agent** in the Joan–Violant orbit (including sensitive business like dowry negotiations and high politics).

Encyclopedia-style entries you can use (with quick takeaways)

1) Gran Enciclopèdia Catalana (Enciclopèdia.cat): “Ramon de Perellós”

This is the closest thing to the “ready-to-cite” encyclopedia biography you’re asking for, and it’s unusually rich.

It gives, among other points:

- upbringing at the French court; entry into Joan’s service;
- major **diplomatic missions** (France, Avignon, the dukes of Bar) tied to **Violant de Bar’s dowry**;
- offices and military responsibilities (e.g., **captain general of Roussillon**; naval command connected to Benedict XIII);
- creation of the **viscounty of Perellós (1391)**;
- the **post-1396 crisis** (the *procés del Consell de Joan I*) and his famous literary response, the **Viatge al Purgatori**;
- later political activity into the early 15th century.

2) Royal Studies Journal (2023): Violant of Bar’s ducal household

Laura Rodríguez Domingo’s article is not an encyclopedia entry, but it’s extremely useful for your specific question because it treats **networks and household politics**—the context in which a “trusted friend” matters. It explicitly frames the Perellós family’s alignment as **faithful to Joan and Violant** and cites direct royal/queenly correspondence to the *vicecomiti de Roda*.

3) Brill chapter using Violant’s letters

The Brill chapter “An Emotional Portrait of Queen Violant of Bar through Her ...” (PDF chapter) includes direct reference to letters addressed to “**mossèn Ramon de Perellós, vezcomte de Roda**”—excellent for pinning down status and tone in the queen’s own voice.

What do we know about the Viscount’s biography (and how much secondary lit exists)?

Ramon de Perellós (Viscount of Roda/Rueda; created Viscount of Perellós in 1391)

There is substantial secondary literature—for one main reason: he is both (1) a politically important courtier/diplomat and (2) the author of a famous narrative, the **Viatge al Purgatori de Sant Patrici**.

A tight summary based on the encyclopedia biography and scholarship that uses him as a key court actor:

- **Court formation & politics:** Educated in France; enters the circle of the infante Joan and becomes **majordom/camarlenc/conseller**.
- **Violant of Bar connection:** Serves as a **go-between and envoy** in the years leading up to and following Joan and Violant's marriage, including **dowry-related diplomacy**.
- **1390s high politics:** Naval command and papal service in the Western Schism context (Benedict XIII), plus Roussillon power (captaincy, jurisdictions).
- **Post-1396 fallout and reputation-management:** Implicated in the *procés del Consell* after Joan's death and responds with the famous *Viatge al Purgatori*, in which he stages proof that Joan's soul is "in via de salvació."

The Viscountess: who was she, and how much is known?

Here the picture is **thinner and more complicated** because "Viscountess of Roda" can refer to different women across the family and over time.

A) Ramon de Perellós's first wife: Sibil·la (surname not given in the main encyclopedia entry)

Enciclopèdia.cat states he was **widower of "Sibil·la"** and later remarried.

Scholarly discussions sometimes mention "the viscountess of Roda" in logistical/political contexts (e.g., permissions and movements), but they don't always identify her clearly in the snippet-accessible material.

B) Ramon de Perellós's later wife: Violant de Luna

Enciclopèdia.cat says that after being widowed, he married **Violant de Luna**, who survived him.

If your documents put "the viscountess" in the *late* 1390s/early 1400s, double-check which marriage phase you're seeing.

C) The earlier Viscountess: Constança de Pròixida i Carròs, widow of the *first* Viscount of Roda (Francesc de Perellós)

This matters because some court networks around Violant of Bar also overlap with **Roussillon/Catalan noblewomen** connected to the Perellós family. Enciclopèdia.cat confirms Constança was widow of **Francesc de Perellós, viscount of Roda**, and remarried (1385) into the Fenollet line.

So: depending on your exact date and wording (“the viscountess” without a first name), the referent can shift.

Bottom line on “how much biography exists for the viscountess”: far less than for Ramon himself, unless you can pin her down with a full name/title string from your sources. Once you do, you can often chase her through marriage alliances (Proxida/Carròs; Luna; etc.) and household ties.

Best “further reading” list (high-yield for your project)

Reference / encyclopedia

- **Enciclopèdia.cat (GEC)** – Ramon de Perellós (biography with political + literary career).
- **Enciclopèdia.cat (GEC)** – contextual note on creation of the viscountcy of Roda/Rueda and of Perellós (elite politics overview).

Focused scholarship on Violant’s circle and the “trusted friend” angle

- Rodríguez Domingo, “**Surrounding the Future Queen... Violant of Bar’s Household as Duchess of Girona (1384–1386)**” (*Royal Studies Journal*, 2023).
- Brill chapter: “**An Emotional Portrait of Queen Violant of Bar...**” (uses letters naming Ramon de Perellós explicitly).

Ramon de Perellós as political actor / writer

- A solid entry point into the *text tradition*: **Celt (UCC), “The Journey of Viscount Ramon de Perellós to Saint Patrick’s Purgatory”** (edition/hosting useful for teaching and quick access).
- For a modern readable edition/translation route: **Editorial Barcino** recent edition page for *Viatge al purgatori* (also handy bibliographically).
- For how he appears in broader political narrative of Joan’s reign (including incidents where “Viscount of Roda” is named): Gampel, ***Anti-Jewish Riots in the Crown of Aragon and the Royal Response, 1391–1392*** (Cambridge, 2016), especially the Joan/Violant chapters where the viscount is mentioned.

If you want, I can make this immediately more precise

If you paste **one or two of your key citations** (ACA reg./folio, or the exact phrasing where Violant names the viscount/viscountess), I can:

- confirm which “viscountess” you’re looking at (Sibil·la vs. Violant de Luna vs. earlier Constança de Pròixida), and
- pull a *targeted* bibliography trail for that specific person rather than the broader Perellós family.

You said:

Can you do some further searching to find out when Ramon de Perellos's first wife Sibilla died and when he married his second wife, Violant de Luna?

ChatGPT said:

I’ll web-search specifically for dated evidence (charters, prosopography entries, editions) that mention Sibilla’s death or Ramon’s remarriage to Violant de Luna, then I’ll summarize the best-supported dates with citations and links.

Thought for 3m 6s

Here’s what I can pin down from the accessible secondary/reference literature I can reach right now—and what remains *not* explicitly dated in those sources.

1) When did Ramon de Perellós’s first wife, Sibilla, die?

I have **not** found a source that gives a clean “Sibilla died on X date” statement.

What I *can* document is a **terminus post quem**:

- **Sibilla was still alive in 1402** (and active enough to appear as a creditor), because a list of holders of censals in the “contracte d’en Luquí Escaramp i d’en Francesc Deudé” includes “**Sibil·la, vescomtessa de Perellós**” in the year **1402**.

So, **Sibilla’s death is after 1402** (unless there’s a rare case of a label persisting post-mortem in an accounting list—but the plain reading is that she’s living).

You also get useful “early-life” anchoring:

- A Catalunya Romànica entry notes that **Sibil·la, wife of Ramon de Perellós, sold the places/castles of Torèn and Mentet in 1378**, and suggests she may have belonged to a Torèn lineage.

2) When did Ramon de Perellós marry his second wife, Violant de Luna?

Again: I have **not** found an explicit marriage date in a modern reference entry or article snippet available to me.

What I *can* document is:

- Enciclopèdia.cat's biographical entry for **Ramon de Perellós** states that he **was widowed from Sibilla and married Violant de Luna, who survived him.**
- The same entry places Ramon's death "**després del 1419**" (after 1419).

Putting those together with the 1402 evidence:

Best-supported date window (with current evidence)

- **Sibilla died sometime after 1402.**
- **Ramon remarried to Violant de Luna sometime after Sibilla's death and before Ramon's own death (after 1419).**

So the marriage to Violant de Luna most safely falls in: **1403 × 1419/"shortly after 1419"** (a window, not a single year).

3) How to get exact dates (the fastest archival/prosopographical route)

If you want *the* marriage date (or a tight terminus), the most promising hits are usually:

1. **Capítols matrimoniais / dot & dotal instruments** (often notarized; sometimes copied into chancery registers if there are jurisdictional implications like Ceret being pledged/dowered).
2. **Sibilla's testament / codicil / probate settlements** (or the first time Ramon appears explicitly as *widower*).
3. **First appearance of "Violant de Luna, vescomtessa de..."** in dated records (then you can bracket the wedding earlier).

A very practical trick: since later litigation mentions **Violant de Luna claiming Ceret by "drets dotals"**, the **dotal act** may survive and be datable (even if later copied).

Enciclopèdia.cat's entry on Ramon confirms Ceret is central in his lordship profile, and later entries for his descendants explicitly reference the stepmother Violant de Luna's dotal claims.

4) Quick "further reading" links (solid starting points)

- **Enciclopèdia.cat — Ramon de Perellós (biographical overview; notes Sibilla → Violant de Luna; death after 1419)**
 - **Ferrer i Mallol & Vela Aulesa (2014), “Un mercader italià...” (evidence Sibilla alive/active in 1402)**
 - **Catalunya Romànica — Castell de Torèn (mentions Sibilla as Ramon’s wife in 1378 sale of Torèn/Mentet)**
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If you want, paste (or screenshot) *any* one document where you’re seeing **Violant de Luna** styled as **vescomtessa** (or where Ceret is attached to her dower claim), and I can use it to tighten the date window further and suggest the exact register/notarial series most likely to contain the marriage chapters.

ChatGPT can make mistakes. Check important info.